

THE CATALOGUE OF the rugs of the Brahmaand (universe) Collection, by design prodigy Ashiesh Shah, shows images of them strewn across desert landscapes. The indigo orbs surfacing out of the khaki tones of the dunes in otherworldly contrast—almost like holes on a flat earth—look like portals opening into the deep blue recesses of interstellar space. Made in collaboration with Jaipur Rugs, arguably India's largest handmade rug maker, the mandala-shaped rugs are an outcome of meticulous craft, beginning from the picking, hand carding and spinning of the wool into a very fine yarn and its subsequent weaving with intricate finishing processes. The finished pieces, woven using wool dyed with ombre hues of indigo, vibrate with a fusion of influences—from Rajasthani architecture to miniature paintings, zodiac wheels, Indian sacred geometry, Raza's Bindu paintings and neo tantric art—all of them osmosing into the layered and very Zen geometric patterns of the rugs. The designer further involves weavers and artisans to reinterpret the designs of the Brahmaand series by 'weaving in' their folk motifs and geometrical shapes to create a unique range of rugs called the '**Brahmaand Manchaha**' collection (pictured is a 5 ft x 8 ft oval rug from the collection, priced at ₹9.24 lakh). The term means a universe fashioned by the heart. Charged with the weavers' lived influences and self-guided asymmetrical improvisations, the contemplative core of the design comes alive like the hum of a mantra chant. More than just a fine rug, it is, for some, a personal patch of the infinite.

